

The Lighthouse Keeper

On the edge of the world, where the grey sea met the greyer sky, stood a lighthouse made of white stone. For forty years it had thrown its beam across the water, and for forty years the keeper had climbed its stairs each night.

A Quiet Routine

The keeper's days were simple. At dawn he polished the great lens until it shone. At dusk he lit the lamp and watched the first ships turn toward the harbour, guided by his light.

The Storm

One autumn night the storm came without warning. The wind tore at the shutters and the rain fell sideways. The keeper held the beam steady through the worst of it, until the little boat slipped safely past the rocks.

Afterward

They say the fishermen never knew his name. But every year a basket of fruit and fresh bread appeared at the foot of the tower, left by hands that remembered.